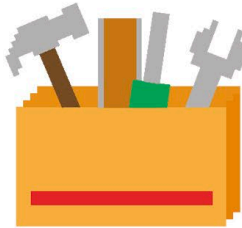


How it works

The program learns about the important events by reading information from a text file – this is called “file input”. The text file contains the name and date of each event. The code calculates the number of days from today until each event using Python’s **datetime** module. It displays the results in a window created by Python’s **Tkinter** module.

► Using Tkinter

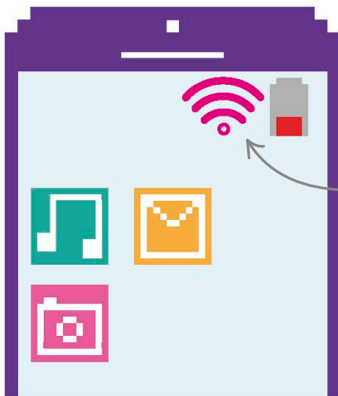
The **Tkinter** module is a set of tools that Python programmers use for displaying graphics and getting input from users. Instead of showing output in the shell, **Tkinter** can display results in a separate window that you’re able to design and style yourself.



■ ■ LINGO

Graphical user interface

A GUI (graphical user interface) is the visible part of a program you interact with, such as the system of icons and menus on a smartphone. Python’s **Tkinter** module allows you to build a GUI by using what we call widgets – packages of ready-made code that create pop-up windows, buttons, sliders, menus and so on.



A smartphone GUI uses icons to show how strong the WiFi signal is and how much power the battery has.

▽ Countdown Calendar flowchart

In this project, the list of important events is created separately from the code as a text file. The program begins by reading in all the events from this file. Once all the days have been calculated and displayed, the program ends.

